IBM i2 Enterprise Insight Analysis

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Product Overview

i2 Enterprise Insight Analysis is designed to help your organization turn overwhelming and disparate data into actionable insight and intelligence in near real time. From national security, defence, and law enforcement to cyber and enterprise-wide threats, the solution helps you develop a comprehensive understanding of your threat landscape to identify vulnerabilities and disrupt threats. The combination of machine-led analytics and human-led analysis capabilities helps you quickly find hidden connections and critical patterns buried in internal, external, and open-source data.

i2 Enterprise Insight Analysis:

- Provides advanced analytics and visual analysis capabilities to help expedite data processing and manual tasks so you can spend more time on analysis.
- Supports interoperability by integrating with third-party software and offers open-source data connectors to leverage existing data and systems to collect new data and securely share your intelligence.
- Is modular and cost effective because it is designed to be scalable and interoperable so that it can be extended with add-on capabilities. You benefit from a cost-effective solution that reduces training, maintenance, and deployment costs.

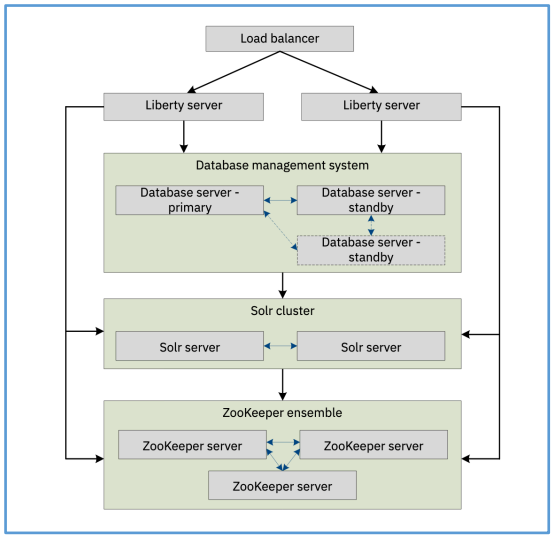
New Features in 2.3.4

i2 Analyze Information Store high availability and disaster recovery (HADR)

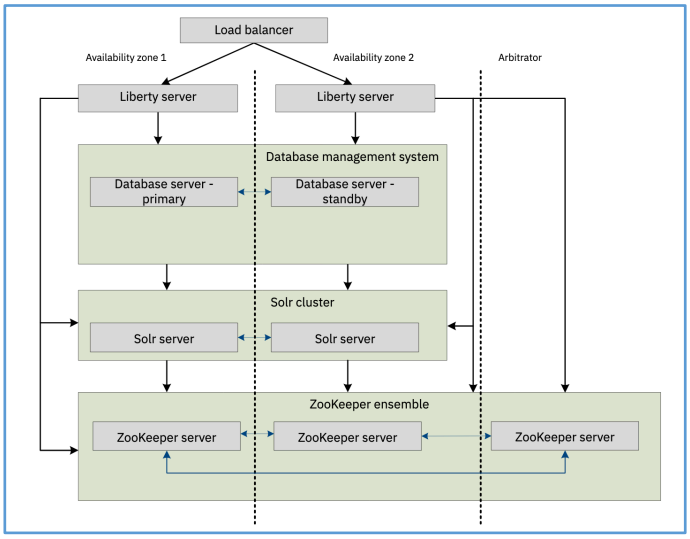
i2 Analyze now provides support for high availability and disaster recovery deployment patterns, to maximise system availability and productivity, and to minimize the risk of data loss. In a high availability deployment i2 Analyze utilizes multiple servers and a load balancer to ensure that users can access i2 Analyze even if one or more servers are unavailable. If disaster recovery is required, then the multiple servers are deployed across availability zones. By deploying across a number of availability zones, the deployment continues to function even if one of the zones completely fails.

High availability and disaster recovery in i2 Analyze supports an active/active pattern with the exception of the database management system which utilizes an active/passive pattern where the primary server is supported by one or more standby servers which take over when the primary server is unavailable. This switchover will occur automatically if configured in the database management system.

High Availability



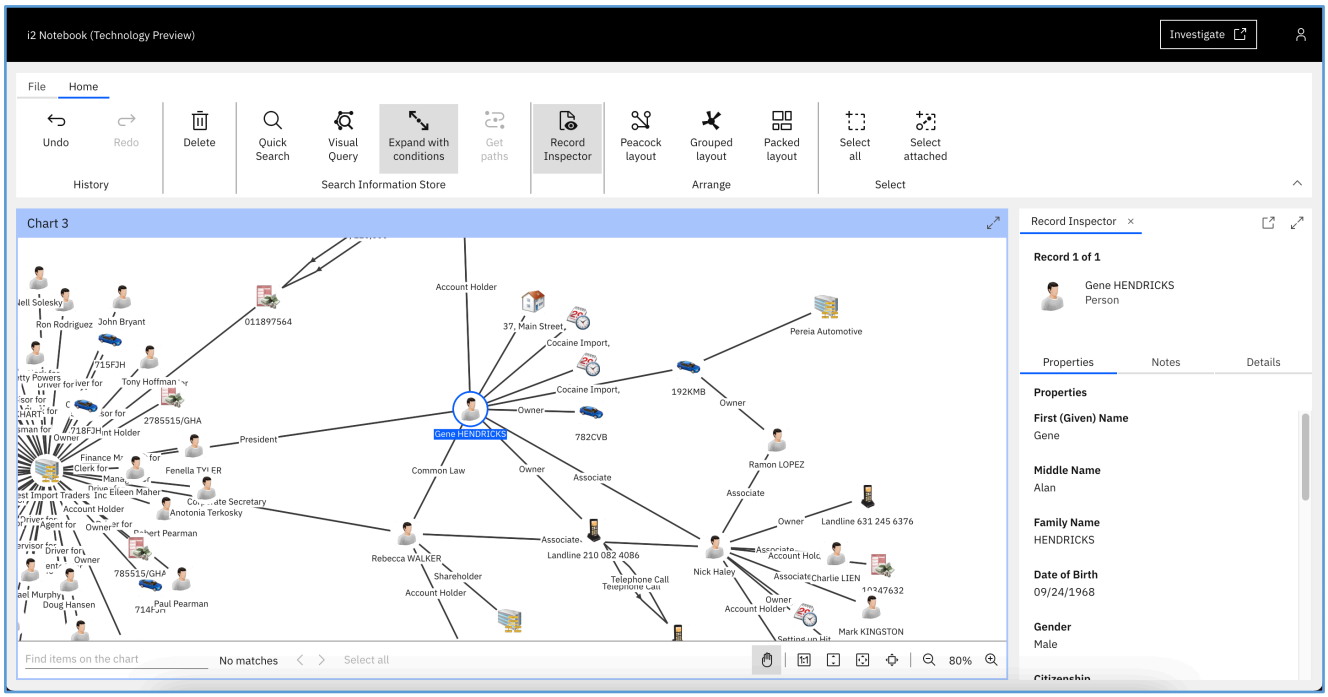
Disaster Recovery



i2 Notebook Technology Preview

This release of i2 Enterprise Insight Analysis includes a technology preview of the i2 Notebook web client, giving users the ability to test this early release preview with their own data and provide feedback and input to help inform the ongoing development effort. This technology preview must not be used for production purposes.

The i2 Notebook provides Quick Search, Visual Query, Expand with Conditions, Record Inspector and Get Paths capabilities; along with Peacock, Grouped, and Packed layouts, and chart navigation tools. Access to the information store is read-only; analysts cannot create, modify or annotate information store records from i2 Notebook.



i2 Analyze Docker containerised deployment

The use of Docker containers in production deployments is now supported, enabling i2 Analyze as part of i2 Enterprise Insight Analysis to be deployed using a cloud service. Documentation, scripts, and artifacts for deploying Docker images are provided in a GitHub repository.

i2 Analyze Information Store enhanced Bulk import mode

IBM i2 Enterprise Insight Analysis delivers performance and flexibility improvements for bulk ingestion of data when using Microsoft SQL Server with the information store. These improvements were previously only available for IBM Db2.

The enhanced Bulk import mode is particularly well suited to ingesting large amounts of data from an external source for the first time.

Flexibility improvements for bulk ingestion include options to drop and recreate database indexes during ingestion, validate that records do not already exist in the information store, and improvements in failure recovery. Additional performance optimisations maximise data ingestion performance.

i2 Analyze Information Store Bulk Delete mode

A Bulk Delete mode has been introduced to improve the performance of the toolkit commands used to delete information store provenance data. This new mode improves the deletion performance of unwanted data that has either been incorrectly ingested or is no longer required.

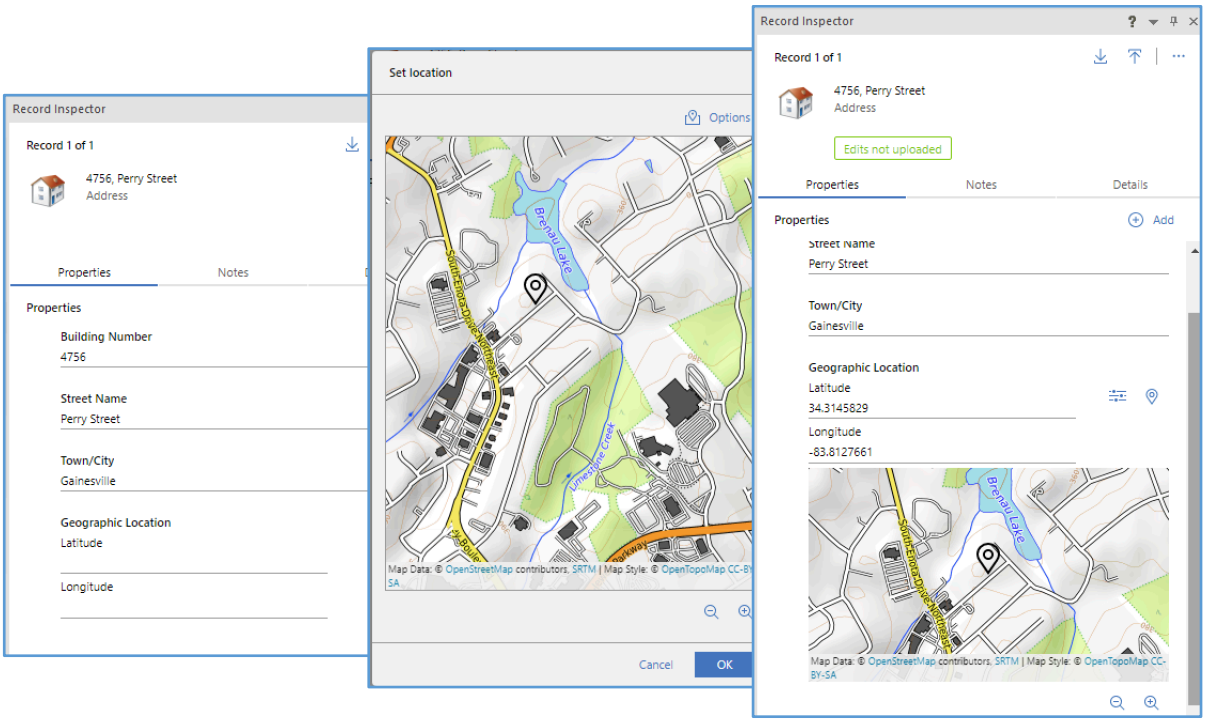
Analyst's Notebook Premium - Combine matching i2 Analyze records on paste

When Analyst's Notebook Premium copies and pastes i2 Analyze records between charts it resolves matches between the records copied from the source chart and records already present in the target chart to limit data duplication and chart clutter. When matches are found, Analyst's Notebook Premium determines the best way to combine or unite the source and target records based on the type of record.

Record matching when copying and pasting is based on the record identifiers, source identifiers, and any system match rules that have been configured.

Analyst's Notebook Premium - i2 Analyse Information Store manual geocode

The Analyst's Notebook Premium record inspector allows a user to manually position a geo-enabled record at its approximate location on the record inspector mini map in order to provide coordinates for the record. An analyst can now easily provide coordinates for a record that they know the location of either through local knowledge or descriptive information.



Analyst's Notebook Premium - i2 Connect flexible schemas

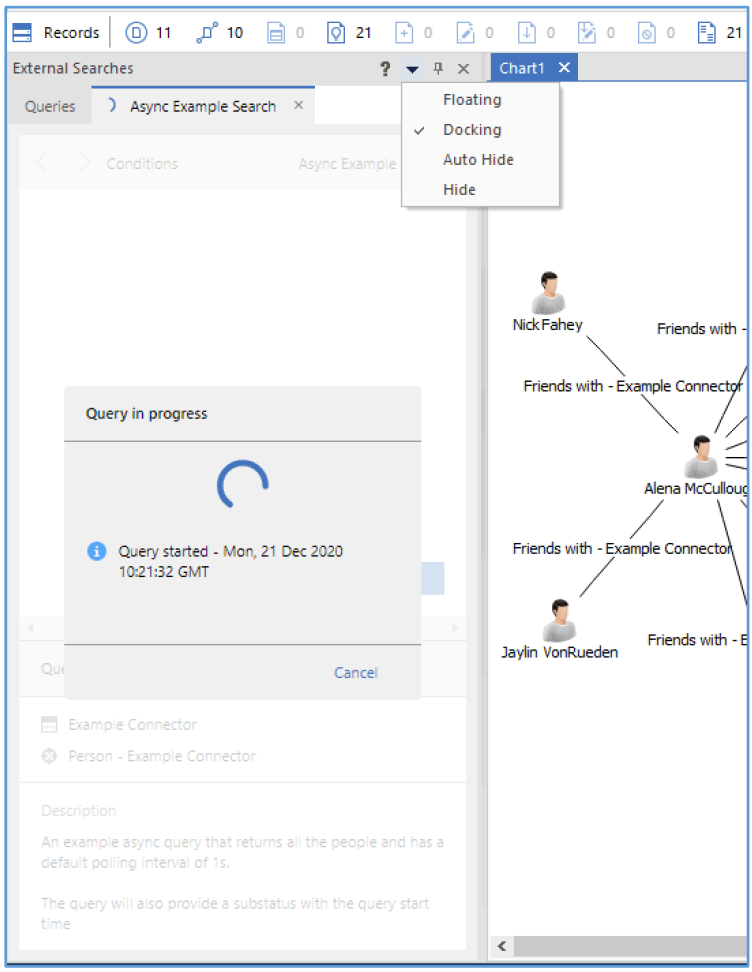
Analyst's Notebook Premium provides flexible schema support with i2 Connect, facilitating the charting and analysis of search results from connectors with different schemas. In previous versions all connectors were required to use the same i2 Analyze schema (or a schema fragment). This change makes the creation and deployment of connectors easier and more flexible.

Records from i2 Connect can now be charted as i2 Analyze records using the individual connectors schema. These "unaligned" records can be used with Analyst's Notebook features including conditional formatting, live formatting, and find matching records.

A system administrator can optionally configure item type conversion between the different connector schemas to provide a consistent chart schema, reducing chart complexity, and to allow record matching to occur across aligned item types.

Analyst's Notebook Premium – i2 Connect asynchronous searches

i2 Connect external searches that do not return results quickly, either due to the volume of results or poor performance of the data source can be setup by an administrator to run asynchronously. Once started, these asynchronous searches continue to run on the server allowing the user to return at a later time to view the results, even if they have disconnected from the i2 Analyze server.



i2 Connect can display status messages in Analyst's Notebook Premium to indicate the current state of a long running search, for example to indicate when the search was started, that a search is still running, or that the search has failed. The messages displayed are configured by an administrator when developing the connector for an external data source.

Analyst's Notebook Premium – other new features

- i2 Connect external searches from Analyst's Notebook Premium now support geospatial point conditions.
- The Analyst's Notebook Premium Quick Search and External Search tools are now dockable to provide a flexible analysis desktop to suit both single and multiple screen workspaces.

i2 Connect capability - i2 Analyze type conversion console

i2 Connect as part of i2 Enterprise Insight Analysis provides an i2 Analyze type conversion console for administrators to assist with schema item type conversion. This interactive tool can be used to map the conversion of item types and properties from a connector schema to one or more gateway schemas or straight to the information store schema.

Once schemas have been aligned to a common schema, analysts benefit from a consistent chart schema, reduced chart complexity, and record matching across aligned item types.

Other i2 Enterprise Insight Analysis changes

The i2 Analysis Repository is no longer supported with i2 Enterprise Insight Analysis. i2 Analyze license holders are entitled to transition to i2 Enterprise Insight Analysis licenses and to use either the information store or iBase repositories.

Pre-requisites

Pre-requisites for IBM i2 Analyze

- IBM DB2 10.5, 11.1, 11.5
- Microsoft SQL Server 2017, 2019
- IBM HTTP Server 9 (Optional)

For full details covering all IBM i2 products see: https://ibm.biz/Bdfdse

Hardware requirements

For full details covering all included IBM i2 products see: https://ibm.biz/Bdfdse

Included IBM Software

- IBM i2 Analyze
- IBM i2 Analyst's Notebook Premium
- IBM i2 Analyst's Notebook Connector to Esri
- IBM i2 Notebook Technology Preview (web client, not for production use)
- IBM i2 Information Exchange for Analysis Search for Analyst's Notebook
- IBM i2 iBase
- IBM Cognos Analytics
- IBM Cognos Framework Manager
- IBM InfoSphere Information Server
- DB2 11.5 Standard Edition

Optional add-ons

- Recommendation Engine
    - IBM InfoSphere Identity Insight
- Investigate
    - i2 Analyze (Investigate web client)

Languages

For full details covering all included IBM i2 products see: https://ibm.biz/Bdfdse

Operating System Support for i2 Analyze

- Windows Server 2012 R2 Essentials, Standard, and Datacenter
- Windows Server 2016 Essentials, Standard, and Datacenter
- Windows Server 2019 Essentials, Standard, and Datacenter
- Linux™ Red Hat Enterprise V7 (Server only)
- Linux™ Red Hat Enterprise V6.1 (Server only)
- Microsoft Windows 10 Pro, and Enterprise (Client only)

This, and future releases of i2 Enterprise Insight Analysis are only supported on the latest update or service pack for each supported Microsoft Windows version as listed at http://windows.microsoft.com/en-gb/windows/lifecycle

For full details covering all included IBM i2 products see: https://ibm.biz/Bdfdse